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THE UNDER SECRETARY OF STATE
WASHINGTON

February 1, 1944

Dear Mr. Secretary:

The Department has had under consideration and has discussed with the British a project for assisting Jewish and other refugees now located in France and Rumania. While these plans have not taken definite form, it is proposed that efforts be made to enable the persons in question to leave Rumania and France and be transferred to places of temporary residence in the colonies formerly occupied by the Italians. The Department has been informed that there are at the present time in North Africa partially abandoned cities where buildings and water supply exist and where food could presumably be supplied by the United Nations Relief and Rehabilitation Administration. This plan, to be successful, would, of course, require the close cooperation of the military authorities.

We were just on the point of communicating with the Joint Chiefs of Staff to obtain an expression of opinion from them regarding locations in North Africa which might be made available for this purpose and also as to whether there might be any valid military objections to such an undertaking.

In connection with this plan, the problem of transportation is, of course, an important one since refugees might arrive out of France into Spain or out of Rumania into Turkey in considerable numbers. We had also intended to raise with the Joint Chiefs of Staff the question of transportation to determine whether or not the military might be able to make shipping available for this purpose. Our experience would seem to indicate that complete dependence could not be

The Honorable
Henry Morgenthau, Jr.,
Secretary of the Treasury

(Original to Mr. Friedman - 2/7/44)